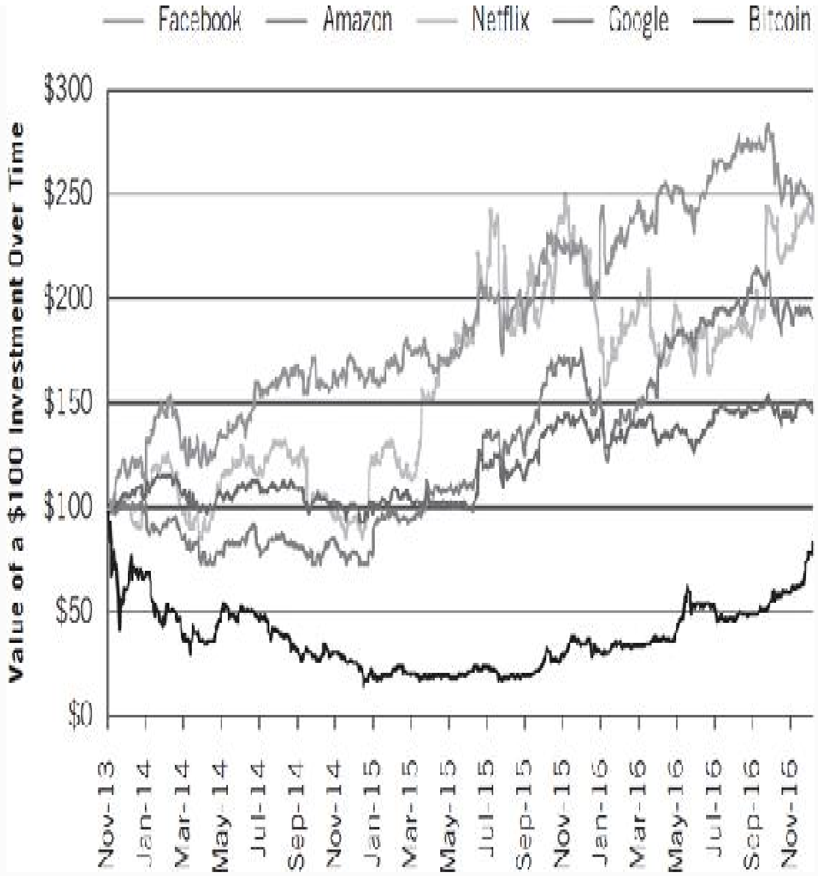

Figure 7.7 Bitcoin's performance compared to the FANG stocks since its November 2013 peak

Data sourced from Bloomberg and CoinDesk

At that same peak in price, innovative investors who chose bitcoin over a nonequity holding—such as bonds, real estate, gold, or oil—would have been the most at peace with their decision (Figure 7.8). The performance of commodities like gold and oil have been far from stellar since November 2013, and in the period up to January 2017, bitcoin actually outperformed oil. The low interest rate environment meant bonds conserved investors' capital but didn't grow it much. In this group, U.S. real estate was the only investment that appreciated on par with the equity markets.